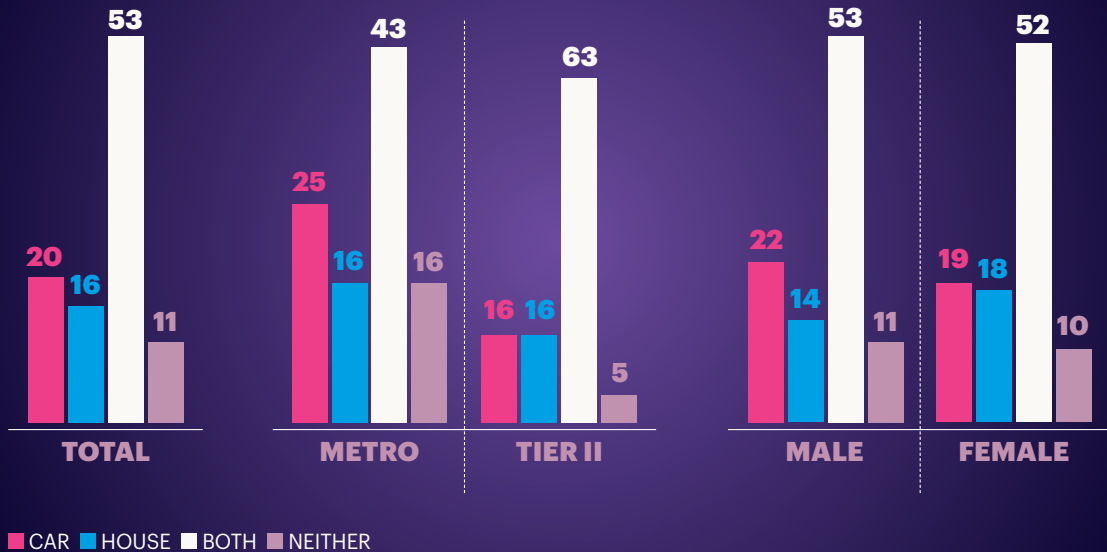


ASSET-LIGHT

• Across all regions, over half aspire to buy both a car and a house



NOTE FIGURES IN %

SOURCE BT-PRICE GENZ CONSUMPTION BEHAVIOUR SURVEY

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ity, youth-centric housing should prioritise productivity and social integration. “By designing buildings with contemporary amenities, whether integrated co-working spaces, high-speed fibre optics, or content-creation studios, developers can transform the home from a mere living space into a functional ‘earning space’ tailored to the modern workforce,” says Baijal.

THE FUTURE

Young buyers are adopting innovative models like co-buying with friends or family and fractional ownership to overcome the lack of affordability in metros, says CBRE’s Magazine. Developers who cater to affordability, sustainability, and digital convenience are best positioned to capture this segment in the coming years.

Bengaluru-based Prestige Group is aligning its product offerings

and experiences to meet the expectations of Gen Z. “This includes enhancing digital engagement, offering virtual property tours, flexible financing options and curated homes with wellness-focused amenities,” says Praveer Shrivastava, Sr. Executive VP, Residential, Prestige Group. Further, the removal of house rent allowance benefits in the new tax regime underlines the cost of long-term renting and naturally shifts the economic calculus in favour of ownership, says Shrivastava. “We believe this will contribute to an uptick in ownership intent among young professionals, particularly in emerging micro markets where pricing remains accessible,” says Shrivastava.

While owning a house remains a distant dream for a majority of Gen Z, they mostly agree on their second-biggest purchase, a car. Pandita, who bought his first car last year, says it

has become a necessity.

Gen Z customers look for connected cars and other tech features, says Partho Banerjee, Senior Executive Officer, Marketing & Sales, Maruti Suzuki. While buying his first car, Pandita wasn’t much concerned about mileage. Powerful engine, driving experience, service network, and safety rating were on the top of his checklist. “Earlier, fuel efficiency and cost of ownership were the top priorities. Today, Gen Z is more interested in connected cars, infotainment systems, and tech like ADAS. They are tech-driven,” he says.

As far as buying a home is concerned, until prices, products and policies catch up with how this generation lives and earns, renting—once seen as a compromise—has become a deliberate choice. **BT**

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